countdown to catching Sivarasan in Konanakunte, Bangalore, Captain Ravi repeatedly pleaded for timely action on the hideout where Sivarasan and gang were holed up. But it took the agencies thirty-six hours to act and allow him to storm the hideout.

P. CHANDRASEKHARAN (44): Director, Tamil Nadu Forensics Lab

He was considered the czar of Indian forensic science. He made the first breakthrough in the Rajiv Gandhi assassination case while the CBI was groping in the dark. His deconstruction of the bomb and analysis of the evidence collected from the scene of crime revealed that the former Prime Minister was killed by a ‘human bomb’ and deduced that she was wearing a denim vest jacket underneath her salwar kameez. The bomb had been packed in the vest jacket. Within forty-eight hours, from the evidence collected from the blast site, he reconstructed the vest bomb, and its mechanical and electrical circuit. From the photographs published in newspapers, Chandrasekharan spotted a camera stuck in the heaps of bodies. Suspecting the final moments of the assassination had been captured on a camera, he launched a hunt for it and eventually got it from the CID, Madras Police. The camera belonged to the photographer Haribabu, who died in the blast. Chandrasekharan developed the film roll from the camera and extracted ten photographs, of which the first showed the human bomb Dhanu and the mastermind behind the assassination, Sivarasan. His achievement gave a major boost to CBI’s investigation.